book, I had even more of a fatherly pride in Mike than I had had before: I could almost see a transformation taking place as the book progressed, as if it was begun by an unhappy and rebellious young man and ended by a completely different person who was happy and at peace with himself. Mike described a journey of discovery in which he learned he had rebelled against the knowledge that his biological mother didn't want him and had done things to get even. I've since recommended his book many times as an aid to those who are adopted—it can help them understand themselves and their families.

After Nancy and I were married, Maureen was away at school, so we didn't get to see her as much as we wanted to. When I ran for the presidency, she went out and worked hard campaigning for me, and that meant a great deal to Nancy and me. Once we were in the White House, she stayed with us often because she was co-chairman of the Republican National Committee and we grew even closer. It was wonderful for us to be able to spend so much time together, and we were always delighted when our son-in-law, Dennis, was able to join us during Maureen's visits.

Patti, as I've mentioned, cried over the telephone when Nancy and I called her at school to tell her I'd been elected governor. "Oh, no," she said, "how could you do this to me?" She was only fourteen, but she was a child of the sixties who didn't want a member of the establishment in the family. Later on, Patti came under the influence of people with similar views and, philosophically, at least, I guess I lost her.

As president, I was devoting every effort I could to ending the threat of nuclear war. But Patti was convinced I was doing the opposite. She just didn't believe in me.

I suppose because we both knew where we stood, we generally avoided this topic when I was in the White House. But two weeks after I gave my speech about the MX missile